

The Emacs Series

Exploring dash.el Further

We will continue to look at the functions available in dash.el, which is a list library for Emacs, in this third part of the series of articles on it.



As stated in the previous article in this series, the dash.el library has been written by Magnar Sveen and the latest version is v2.16.0. The source code of dash.el is available at <https://github.com/magnars/dash.el>, and is released under the GNU General Public License v3.0. The dash.el package is available in Milkypostman's Emacs Lisp Package Archive (MELPA) and in the Marmalede repo. You can install the package using the following command in GNU Emacs:

```
M-x package-install dash
```

You will require the function combinators, and hence you should also install the following:

```
M-x package-install dash-functional
```

The other method of installation is to copy the dash.el source file to your Emacs load path and use it.

In order to get syntax highlighting of dash functions in Emacs buffers, you can add the following to your Emacs initialisation settings:

```
(eval-after-load 'dash '(dash-enable-font-lock))
```

Usage

In this article, we will explore more list operations, threading macros, binding constructs, destructive operations and function combinators.

List operations: The *-rotate* function shifts the elements to the right or left, based on an input count. A positive value of count shifts the elements to the right, while a negative number shifts them to the left. For example:

```
(-rotate count list) ;; Syntax
```

```
(-rotate 3 '(1 2 3 4 5))
(3 4 5 1 2)
```

You can repeat an element count a number of times to create a new list using the *-repeat* function. An example is given below:

```
(-repeat count list) ;; Syntax
```

```
(-repeat 3 :foo)
(:foo :foo :foo)
```

The *-cons** function is used to create a new list from the arguments given to it. For example:

```
(-cons* arguments) ;; Syntax
```

```
(-cons* 1 2 3)
```

```
(1 2 . 3)
```

You can append an element to the end of a list using the